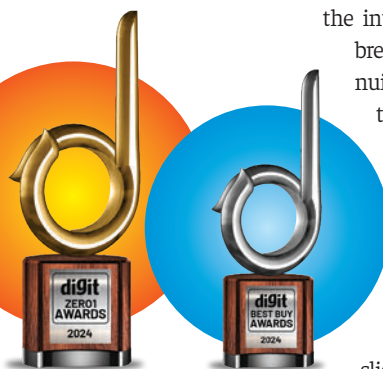




Foldable smartphones have transitioned from a futuristic concept to a dynamic reality, reshaping the mobile landscape with each passing year. In 2024, the foldable phone market has seen remarkable advancements, both in technology and user acceptance, with brands pushing the envelope on design, durability, and functionality. From larger foldable screens that seamlessly transform into tablets to compact clamshells offering enhanced portability, the innovation in this segment is redefining how we interact with our devices. India, one of the largest smartphone markets globally, has embraced foldable technology with growing enthusiasm. As prices become more competitive and after-sales support improves, Indian consumers are increasingly drawn to these devices for their multitasking capabilities and aspirational value. Leading brands like Samsung, Motorola, Google, and Vivo have made significant inroads, catering to tech-savvy millennials and professionals seeking both style and substance. 2024 has also seen foldable phones overcoming earlier criticisms, such as fragile displays and bulky designs. The adoption of Ultra-Thin Glass (UTG), better hinge mechanisms, and water-resistant foldables has strengthened consumer confidence. Coupled with aggressive marketing and EMI options, foldables are no longer niche products but contenders in the mainstream smartphone market in India. The future, quite literally, is unfolding. Let's see which foldable snagged our Digit Zero1 Award this year.

Foldable Smartphone

Innovation unfolded



Vivo X Fold 3 Pro
Price: ₹1,59,999

Winner and Best Buy: Vivo X Fold 3 Pro

If there's one foldable phone in 2024 that has turned heads and raised eyebrows, it's the Vivo X Fold3 Pro. This isn't just another foldable; it's a statement. Vivo has gone all out with this one, and the results are nothing short of impressive. Let's talk performance first. With the Snapdragon 8 Gen 3 under the hood, the X Fold3 Pro runs circles around most competitors. It crushes benchmarks, both in CPU and GPU tests, scoring higher than the Z Fold 6 in multiple tests. The phone delivers a buttery-smooth experience whether you're gaming, multitasking, or flipping through apps on its gorgeous foldable display. And speaking of displays, Vivo has upped the ante here. The X Fold3 Pro's AMOLED panel isn't just brighter than the Z Fold 6; it's punchier, more vibrant, and a joy to use even in glaring sunlight. Then there's the camera setup, which feels like it belongs on a premium flagship rather than a foldable. Zeiss-tuned lenses, stunning low-light shots, and a periscope zoom that puts Samsung's offering to shame make this the best camera system on any foldable this year. Now here's the kicker: at ₹1,59,999, the Vivo X Fold3 Pro is a steal. It's cheaper than the Z Fold 6 but doesn't skimp on anything, offering flagship-grade cameras, stellar performance, and even battery life that rivals traditional flagships. For anyone on the fence about foldables, this is the one to beat in 2024. It wins not just the Digit Zero1 Award but also the Best Buy Award in this emerging category.

Runner-Up: Samsung Galaxy Z Fold 6

The Samsung Galaxy Z Fold 6 continues to hold its ground as one of the best foldable phones on the market, thanks to Samsung's expertise in crafting foldable devices. While it may not claim the performance crown this year, it excels in areas that matter to everyday users, particularly its user interface and durability. Samsung has refined the foldable experience to near perfection with One UI. Tailored specifically for foldable screens, the interface is seamless and intuitive, making multitasking a breeze. Features like split-screen mode, enhanced app continuity, and multi-window support feel polished, allowing users to make full use of the expansive display. This thoughtful design is a testament to Samsung's years of innovation in the foldable space. Durability is another area where the Galaxy Z Fold 6 shines. With an IP48 rating and Gorilla Glass Victus 2, it's built to withstand the rigors of daily use, including unexpected splashes and minor drops. The hinge mechanism also feels sturdier than ever, adding to the phone's longevity. While the Z Fold 6 may lag slightly behind the Vivo X Fold3 Pro in raw performance and camera prowess, it remains a top choice for those prioritising usability, software, and reliability in a foldable.



Samsung Galaxy Z Fold 6
Price: ₹1,64,999

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